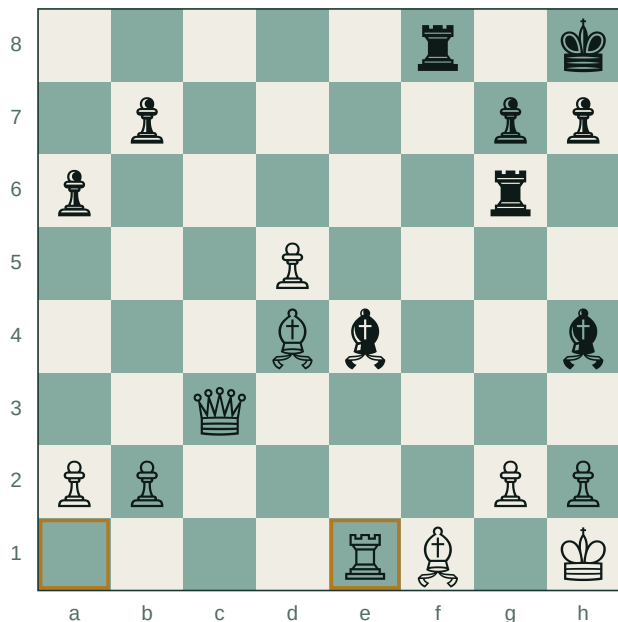


Discovered checks: Black, move 27

Discovered checks

Black to move



Previous move: 27.Re1. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

27...Rxf1+ 28. Rxf1 Bxg2+ 29. Kg1 Bf3#

27...Rxf1+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. From f1 it attacks king on h1 and rook on e1. Recorded reply: **28.Rxf1**.

28...Bxg2+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. From g2 it attacks king on h1 and rook on f1. Recorded reply: **29.Kg1**.

29...Bf3# Mate: rook on g6 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on g1. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on g6. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The checking line must actually be clear, and moving the blocker must not expose your own king to check.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A discovered check opens a line toward the king by moving the blocking piece. Because check must be answered, the moving piece may gain a free tempo for another threat.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the hidden checking line first. Then examine where the blocker can move to attack or capture something important.

The defending king is on h1. Absolute pin: pawn on g2.